

For **Crimson Notepad**, I would structure development into **6 stages**, where every stage ends with a usable product.

Stage 0 — Project Foundation

Goal

Get the project running and establish architecture.

Build

- ✓ GitHub Organization
- ✓ crimson-notepad repository
- ✓ Tauri setup
- ✓ React frontend
- ✓ Rust backend
- ✓ Build Windows executable
- ✓ Dark theme foundation
- ✓ App icon

End Result

Crimson.exe launches

Nothing more.

Stage 1 — Core Editor

Goal

Create the simplest usable note app.

Build

- ✓ Single note editor
- ✓ Markdown text area
- ✓ Auto save
- ✓ Open .md file
- ✓ Save .md file
- ✓ Create new note
- ✓ Unsaved change protection

UI

```
+-----+
| Crimson      |
+-----+
|             |
| Markdown Editor |
|             |
+-----+
```

End Result

User can write notes.

Stage 2 — File System

Goal

Support multiple notes.

Build

- ✓ Notes folder
- ✓ File explorer
- ✓ Create note
- ✓ Rename note
- ✓ Delete note
- ✓ Search note
- ✓ Recent notes

UI

```
+-----+-----+
| Notes  | Current Note |
|-----+-----+
| ML.md  |                   |
| OS.md  |                   |
| AI.md  |                   |
+-----+-----+
```

End Result

Usable as a daily note-taking app.

Stage 3 — Crimson's Core Feature

This is where Crimson becomes Crimson.

Goal

Instant access.

Build

- ✓ Global shortcut
- ✓ System tray
- ✓ Hide to tray
- ✓ Reopen from shortcut
- ✓ Fast startup
- ✓ Last note restore

Workflow

```
Studying
↓
Ctrl+C+M
↓
Crimson opens
↓
Read roadmap
↓
Ctrl+C+M
↓
Hide
```

End Result

The original problem is solved.

Stage 4 — Study Mode

Goal

Make it ideal for students.

Build

- ✓ Markdown preview
- ✓ Mermaid support
- ✓ Checklists
- ✓ Code blocks
- ✓ Tables
- ✓ Reading mode

Example

```
# ML Roadmap

- Linear Algebra
- Calculus

```mermaid
graph TD
A-->B
```

```
End Result

Roadmaps and study plans become much easier to read.

Stage 5 – Overlay Mode

This is the killer feature.

Goal

Reference notes without opening a full app.

Build

```text
✓ Mini overlay window
✓ Always-on-top mode
✓ Quick note switcher
✓ Transparent background option
✓ Compact reading mode
```

UI

```
+-----+
| ML Roadmap |
|           |
| Linear Algebra |
| Calculus |
+-----+
```

No sidebar.

No clutter.

Just content.

End Result

Feels like a study companion rather than a note app.

Stage 6 — Polish & Distribution

Goal

Make it professional.

Build

```
✓ Settings window
✓ Theme settings
✓ Startup on boot
✓ File associations
✓ Installer
✓ Auto updates
✓ Error logging
✓ About page
```

Deliverables

```
CrimsonSetup.exe
```

Double click.

Install.

Use.

Stage 7 — Future (Do NOT Build Yet)

Only if people actually use it.

Possible Features

- Tags
- Note links
- AI summaries
- Cloud sync
- Mobile app
- Plugin system
- Collaboration

Development Priority

If you started tomorrow:

Month 1

Stage 0
Stage 1
Stage 2

You now have:

A lightweight markdown app

Month 2

Stage 3
Stage 4

You now have:

A useful study tool

Month 3

Stage 5
Stage 6

You now have:

A product people can install

The most important stage is **Stage 3**. That's where Crimson stops being "another markdown editor" and starts solving the specific problem that led you to create it.